

STARTER

Common Refusal Reasons & How to Avoid Them

Australia - Student Visa (Subclass 500)

Student visa refusals are decided by a Department of Home Affairs case officer against the Migration Regulations. Most applications are decided on the written file, which makes a complete, consistent document set especially important.

The most common specific reasons

1. CoE details don't match the application

- Double-check your CoE against every course-related field on the application before submitting
- If your passport is renewed or any personal detail changes after your CoE is issued, tell your provider so the record stays consistent

2. Financial evidence doesn't meet the cost-of-living formula

- The required amount (course fees payable, plus published annual living costs, plus travel, plus any dependant increments) is a formula, not a judgement call - see the Financial Requirements Overview
- Evidence must be genuine, recent, and consistent - a large, unexplained recent deposit is a specific red flag

3. Not satisfied you meet the Genuine Student requirement

The case officer isn't satisfied your intention is genuinely to study this course, that it represents a credible step given your background, or that your circumstances support a genuine study plan.

- Be specific about why this course and provider, and how it fits your academic or career background
- Address any obvious gap or mismatch (a big jump in field of study, a long break since your last qualification) directly rather than leaving it unexplained

4. Missing or insufficient OSHC

OSHC covering your entire intended stay is a mandatory, checked requirement. Missing cover, or cover that doesn't span your full course length, is a specific, avoidable refusal ground.

5. Incomplete or inconsistent immigration history

- Disclose all previous visas, visits, and refusals - from Australia and any other country - honestly
- An undisclosed prior refusal or visa cancellation is treated far more seriously than the underlying history itself would usually be

REVIEW RIGHTS DEPEND ON YOUR SPECIFIC CIRCUMSTANCES

Whether independent merits review is available for a refused Student visa depends on where you applied from and your specific circumstances. Check your refusal letter carefully for what (if any) review right applies to your case. See the Refusal Decision Guide (Premium tier).